

ETHAN (TAEHOON) LEE

ethantlee21@gmail.com · thdxg.dev

Dear Hiring Manager,

Since choosing software engineering as my career, I have been searching for my niche in the industry. I began at the top of the stack. I designed UIs and published a research paper on human-computer interaction. Building web interfaces intrigued me to build the backend and data layer, where I designed APIs and implemented auth and caching. My internship at a cloud infrastructure team in Summer 2025 was an enlightening experience where I solved problems at scale with cloud-native technologies. Fallen in love with Kubernetes and its open-source community, I architected my own Kubernetes cluster to deploy personal projects and contributed upstream to Kubernetes, Next.js, and Echo framework. I went further down to work closely to the metal and operating system, as I entered CMU's master's program with a focus on distributed systems.

I've journeyed through the modern technology stack from top to bottom; I can build the frontend, backend, and the infrastructure to run them on. Counterproductively to my niche-searching, there wasn't a part that I didn't enjoy learning or building. Each layer of the stack came with different problems but taught the same lesson: there's always more than what I know. In today's world, maybe what I need is the passion and vision, not a niche.

I'm drawn to Waggoner because your internal platform is close to what I build now. At Huddle Surety I own both sides of the same boundary you're describing: a Go REST API spanning 100+ endpoints with relationship-based auth and audit logging, and the Next.js and tRPC frontend on top of it, used by surety agents who aren't engineers and who act on what it tells them. I also built the multi-stage RAG pipeline there, which is the same problem as document search and chat over internal knowledge, including the part where being confidently wrong is worse than returning nothing. Advisors making investment decisions raise that stakes further, and that's the constraint I'd want to design against.

I distinguish myself as a disciplined and curious learner with a breadth of engineering experience. Being a Software Engineer Intern at Waggoner is an opportunity that I am ready to make the most out of, and I hope my qualities include what you are looking for.

Sincerely,

Ethan (Taehoon) Lee